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Strategic Trading Analysis

Step 1: Audit the Data

- **Data Present:**
  - Daily, Weekly, and 15-minute price charts.
  - Moving averages (20, 50, 200 EMAs) and crossover analysis.
  - Momentum and trend indicators (MACD, RSI, Bollinger Bands, Supertrend).
  - Volume analysis (distribution/accumulation days, climax churning).
  - Relative Strength analysis against the benchmark sector (^CNXFMCG).
  - High-level fundamental metrics (Revenue, Net Income, ROE, EPS growth rates).
  - Analyst consensus targets and basic valuation checks.
- **Data Missing:**
  - Options chain / Open Interest data for gauging derivative-market sentiment.
  - Broader market index overlay (e.g., NIFTY 50) to assess absolute market headwinds.
  - Detailed institutional holding changes (FII/DII flow).
- **Confidence Level: High**. The provided document offers an exceptionally comprehensive technical and quantitative overview, which is more than sufficient for formulating a robust positional swing trade thesis.

Step 2: Analyze the Setup

- **Price Structure:** ITC.NS has experienced a catastrophic structural breakdown, plummeting from the INR 400-INR 450 distribution zone down to the INR 290-INR 300 area. Currently, the stock is attempting to build a base, but the structure remains heavily compromised.
- **Trend Direction:** The trend is definitively bearish. The EMA crossover summary indicates a "Strong **Downtrend**," with the current price (INR 301.60) trading below the 20, 50, and 200 EMAs. Furthermore, the Supertrend indicator is flashing "DOWNTREND (Sell)" across the 1-Week, 1-Day, and 15-Minute timeframes.
- **Momentum:** Momentum is mixed but leans cautious. While the MACD has registered a bullish crossover (MACD line -0.22 > Signal line -1.43), it remains deep in negative territory, suggesting a corrective bounce rather than a primary trend reversal. Daily MACD momentum is flagged as "Weakening." RSI is neutral at 47.35.
- **Confluence:** Confluence strongly discourages immediate entry. Relative Strength is lagging its sector across all timeframes (1M, 3M, 6M, 1Y). Volume analysis shows ongoing "Distribution Days" (most recently on 2026-04-22), and candlestick classification heavily favors "Seller Control." Short-term net income has seen a severe -73.42% QoQ contraction, adding fundamental weight to the technical sell-off.

Step 3: Formulate the Recommendation

Recommendation: NO

Why invalid: As a risk-averse positional trader, buying into an unconfirmed base during a "Strong **Downtrend**" is equivalent to catching a falling knife. The dominant technical footprint is controlled by sellers, and overhead supply will likely stifle immediate upside. The stock must prove it has absorbed the selling pressure and transitioned into an accumulation phase before capital is committed.

However, given the steepness of the decline, a mean-reversion setup targeting the 200 EMA (gap fill area) is viable *if* price action confirms a bullish structural shift.

Conditional Plan:* **Condition to Buy:** A decisive daily close above both the 50 EMA (INR 310.29) and the

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Daily Supertrend resistance (INR 311.10), ideally accompanied by a volume surge (above the 20-day MA of 21.1M). * **Entry Price:** INR 312.00 (On confirmation of the breakout).* **Stop Loss:** INR 295.00 (A hard close below the recent consolidation base and 20 EMA, representing roughly 5.4% downside risk).* **Take Profit:** INR 354.00 (Targeting the descending 200 EMA and former structural breakdown levels, offering a ~13.4% upside reward).

Candlestick Classification Analysis

As a seasoned price action trader using the provided Candlestick Classification system, I have analyzed the daily chart and the accompanying classification data for ITC.NS (Pages 20 & 21).

Here is my professional interpretation and prediction for the future price movement:

1. Overall Trend & Structural Context

Looking at the broader chart on Page 21, the stock has been in a severe structural downtrend, initiated by a massive **Seller Strong Control (-2)** gap-down event in early January 2026. This move was accompanied by a colossal volume spike, indicating heavy institutional distribution. Since then, the overall distribution of candles heavily favors the bears: **65 Seller Control/Strong Control days vs. only 47 Buyer Control/Strong Control days**. More importantly, the dominant state is **No Control (117 days)**, which tells us that buyers have entirely failed to mount any meaningful, high-conviction counter-offensive.

2. Recent Price Action & Candlestick Analysis

Recently, the stock found a temporary floor near the INR 290 level and attempted a weak relief rally back toward the INR 305-INR 310 zone. However, analyzing the candlestick classifications during this bounce reveals critical weaknesses:* **Lack of Buyer Conviction:** The bounce consists mostly of **Buyer Control (+1)** and **No Control (0)** candles. We do not see strings of *Buyer Strong Control (+2)* candles. According to our algorithm, this means bullish days either have weak closes (upper wicks showing rejection) or are occurring on low volume (triggering the 0.6x volume reduction penalty).* **Return of Sellers:** The latest classification is **Seller Control (-1)**. Right as the price pushed slightly higher, sellers stepped back in. The close was weak, and buyers failed to hold the intraday highs.* **10-Day Average Score (-0.20):** Despite being in a "bounce" phase, the rolling 10-day average is negative. This is a massive red flag for bulls. It means that over the last two trading weeks, net price action conviction is still leaning bearish.

3. Volume Validation

Following Step 4 of the algorithm ("Volume Multiplier - Most Critical"), we must look at the volume pane below the price chart. * The volume during the recent mild upward drift has been visibly declining or flat (below average). * Price rising on low volume implies a lack of institutional participation ("weak hands"). * Conversely, the minor down-days during this consolidation show localized volume upticks, meaning sellers

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are more aggressive on the ask than buyers are on the bid.

Future Price Prediction: BEARISH CONTINUATION

Based on the classification data, **I expect the future price movement to be to the downside.**

Reasoning: The current price action is a low-probability, low-volume "bear flag" or dead-cat bounce. Because the upward move lacks *Buyer Strong Control (+2)* signals and volume backing, it represents a temporary pause in selling rather than a genuine shift in trend. The immediate reappearance of *Seller Control (-1)* at the top of this short-term bounce suggests the smart money is using this minor liquidity pool to initiate new short positions or unload remaining long inventory.

Trade Outlook: Look for the price to reject the current levels (~INR 301) and drift back down to re-test the recent swing lows near **INR 287-INR 290**. Unless we see a high-volume, wide-range *Buyer Strong Control* candle closing near its absolute highs to invalidate this thesis, the path of least resistance remains firmly down.

News & Analyst Targets

As a stock research analyst, I have reviewed the latest market data, corporate filings, and sector trends for ITC Limited as of the final week of April 2026. Here is the comprehensive analysis and news breakdown you requested.

1) Latest News for ITC This Week

- **Major INR 3,498 Crore Acquisition Closing:** ITC is set to officially close its INR 3,498 crore acquisition of Century Pulp and Paper next week. This strategic deal, which faced a year of regulatory delays, will expand ITC's paper and packaging manufacturing capacity by an estimated 50% (to over 1.5 million tonnes annually) and diversify its geographic manufacturing footprint away from southern India.
- **FMCG Portfolio Expansion (Yoga Bar):** Effective April 1, 2026, ITC successfully acquired majority board nomination rights in Sproutlife Foods Private Limited, the parent company of the popular 'Yoga Bar' brand, officially making it a subsidiary. This acquisition accelerates ITC's push into the high-growth, digital-first health foods segment.
- **Institutional Buying & Block Deals:** ITC shares have experienced a slight recovery (up ~5.5% over the past two weeks) largely fueled by Domestic Institutional Investors (DIIs) increasing their stake to 49.15% (up from 48.90%). Notably, the stock also saw a large block trade of 567,029 shares worth roughly INR 16.62 crore on the NSE this week, indicating strong domestic institutional accumulation despite Foreign Institutional Investors (FIIs) trimming their stakes.

2) Upgrades and Downgrades from Brokerages

Following the severe excise duty hikes implemented earlier in the quarter, the broader brokerage consensus has experienced a string of downgrades, though some upgrades based on valuation are emerging.* **MarketsMojo (Upgrade):** Upgraded ITC's rating from a 'Sell' to a 'Hold' in mid-April 2026, citing the stock's tempered but steady fundamentals, liquidity, and large-cap stability amid recent corrections.* **Investec (Downgrade):** Downgraded the stock from 'Buy' to 'Hold' and slashed its price target heavily to INR 367 (from

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INR 492). The brokerage cited an "unprecedented increase in taxation slabs" that poses a major threat to legal cigarette volumes.* **Motilal Oswal (Downgrade):** Downgraded ITC from 'Buy' to 'Neutral' with a revised target of INR 400, citing that ITC would need extreme price hikes of nearly 25% just to maintain net realizations following the tax hike, forecasting an EBIT contraction for FY27. * **Goldman Sachs (Downgrade / Target Cut):** Maintained a 'Neutral' stance but significantly cut its price target down to INR 330 (from INR 385). The brokerage expects weak Q4 earnings due to high FMCG input costs and shrinking cigarette margins.

3) Other News Directly or Indirectly Impacting ITC

- **20% Plunge in April Cigarette Volumes:** A major fundamental headwind right now is the direct aftermath of the 30-40% excise duty hike that went into effect in February 2026. As of April 2026, the overall Indian cigarette market has witnessed a brutal 20% volume decline. The premium "King Size" cigarette segment is taking the sharpest hit, forcing the market to price in structural earnings distress for both ITC and its peer, Godfrey Phillips.
- **Heavy Put Option Activity:** Options market data heading into the late April 2026 expiry highlights a wave of bearish sentiment and portfolio hedging. Substantial put options volumes have clustered around the INR 290, INR 300, and INR 310 strike prices, indicating that derivatives traders are preparing for further downside volatility or hedging their long exposure ahead of upcoming earnings.
- **US Tariff Overhang (Indirect Impact):** Ongoing macroeconomic uncertainties, specifically the new 26% US reciprocal tariff on Indian goods announced in early April 2026, have created an overhang for FMCG companies. This trade tension indirectly impacts ITC by posing risks to its Agribusiness export revenue opportunities and sparking wider FII selling in the Indian equities market.

4) Latest Targets from Analysts Community and Brokerages

Despite the current taxation and volume headwinds dragging the stock near its 52-week lows, the consensus views the stock as a 'Hold/Neutral' with isolated 'Buy' calls anchored on attractive valuations and its non-cigarette FMCG growth.

Brokerage / Research Firm	Target Price (INR)	Stance / Recommendation
Antique Stock Broking	408	Hold / Neutral
Sharekhan	400	Buy
Motilal Oswal	400	Neutral
UBS	395	Buy
Investec	367	Hold
Systematix	355	Hold
Goldman Sachs	330	Neutral

(Note: The overall consensus 12-month analyst target price averages out to approximately INR 432-INR 480, leaning on the prospect of the upcoming ITC Hotels demerger unlocking long-term shareholder value.)

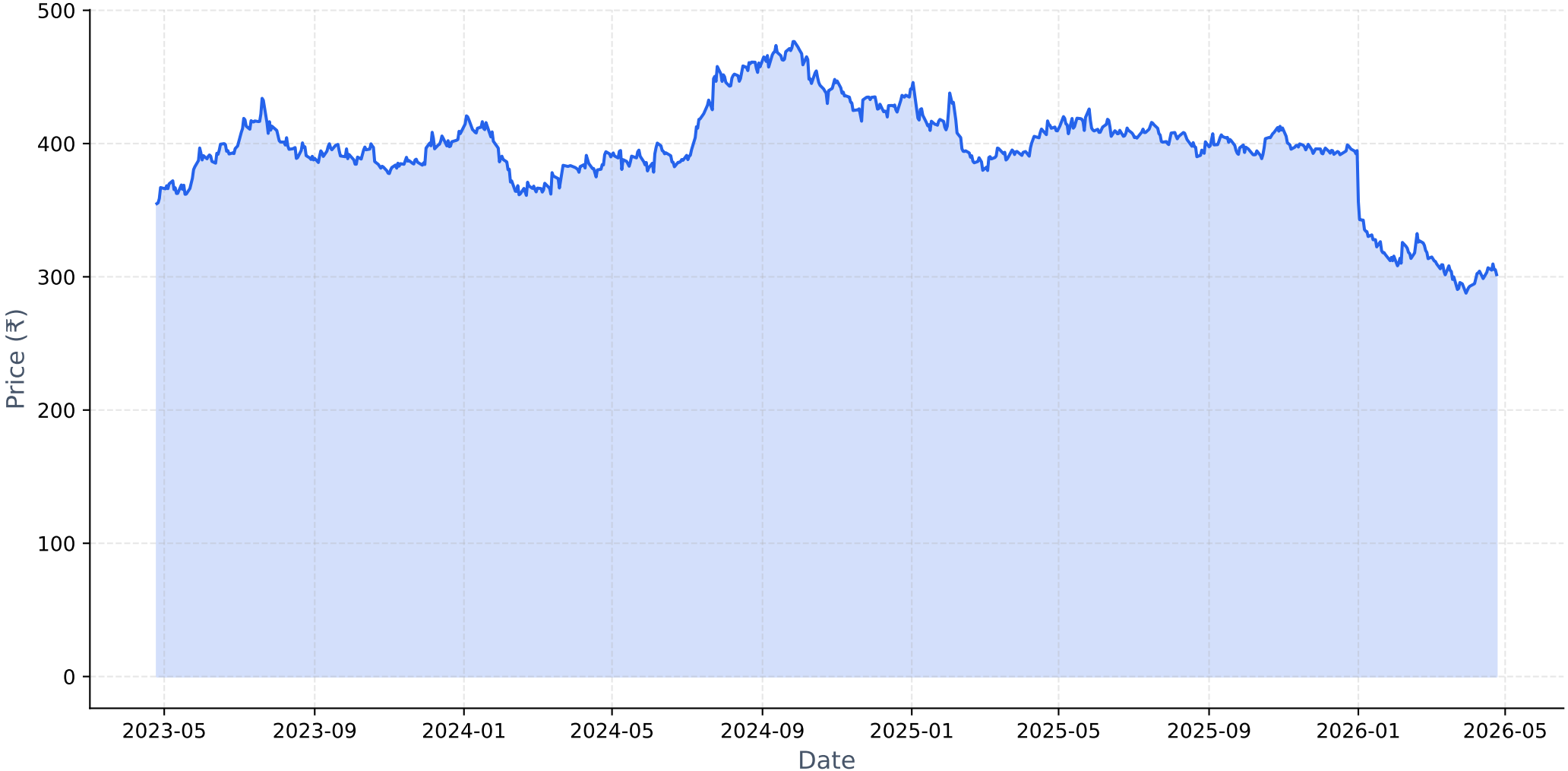
Stock Detailed Analysis Report

ITC.NS

Current Price: ₹301.60

Generated: 2026-04-25 14:28

ITC.NS - 3 Year Daily Price Chart



Long-term Fundamental Analysis (4 Years)

Metric	Is Growing?	Accelerating?	1Y Growth	3Y CAGR
Revenue	Yes	Yes	10.78%	7.51%
Net Income	Yes	Yes	69.84%	31.61%
ROE	Yes	Yes	68.81%	28.40%
EPS	Yes	Yes	69.24%	30.97%

Short-term Fundamental Analysis (6 Quarters)

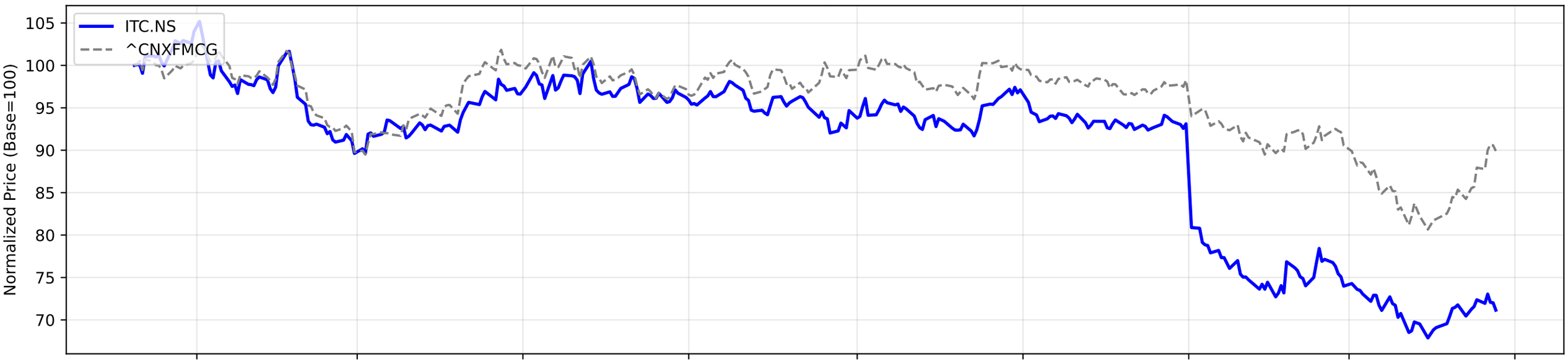
Metric	Is Growing?	Recent QoQ	Avg QoQ
Revenue	Yes	15.12%	2.90%
Net Income	Yes	-73.42%	75.06%
EPS	No	-1.00%	-1.00%

ITC.NS - Relative Strength Analysis

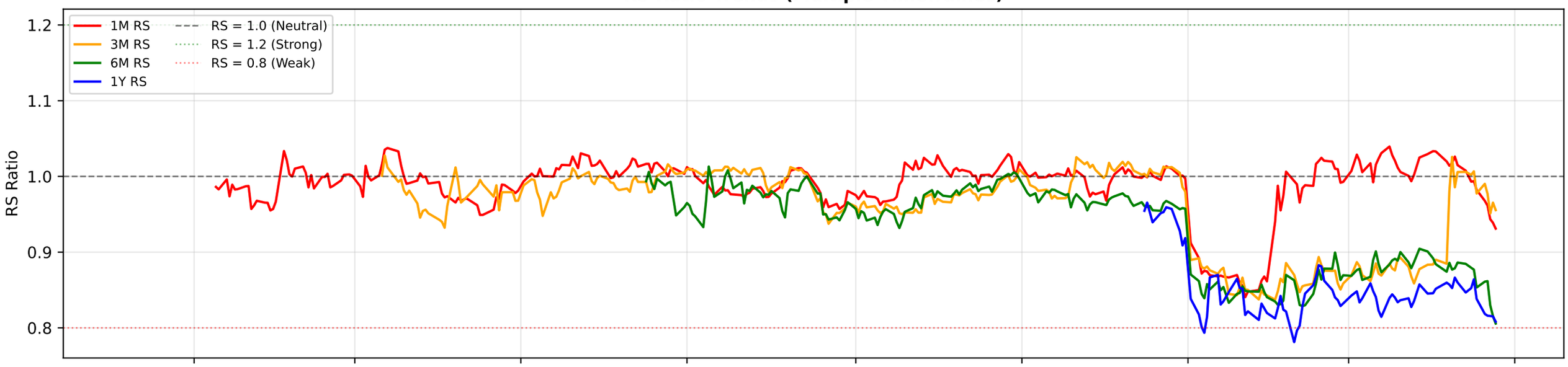
═══ OVERVIEW ═══:	
Benchmark Index:	^CNXFMCG
Sector:	FMCG
Classification:	**Neutral**
RS Score:	44.4/100
:	
═══ RS RATIOS ═══:	
1M RS:	**0.931 [Neutral]**
3M RS:	**0.956 [Neutral]**
6M RS:	**0.806 [Neutral]**
1Y RS:	**0.808 [Neutral]**
:	
═══ TURNAROUND ANALYSIS ═══:	
Turnaround Status:	**Not Detected**
:	
SIGNAL CRITERIA::	
✗ **Emerging RS:**	**Not accelerating**
✓ **Medium-term Lagging:**	6M=0.806, 1Y=0.808 (≤1.0)
✓ **Performance Improving:**	3M (-5.6%) > 6M (-24.0%)

Relative Strength Analysis: ITC.NS vs ^CNXFMCG
Classification: Neutral

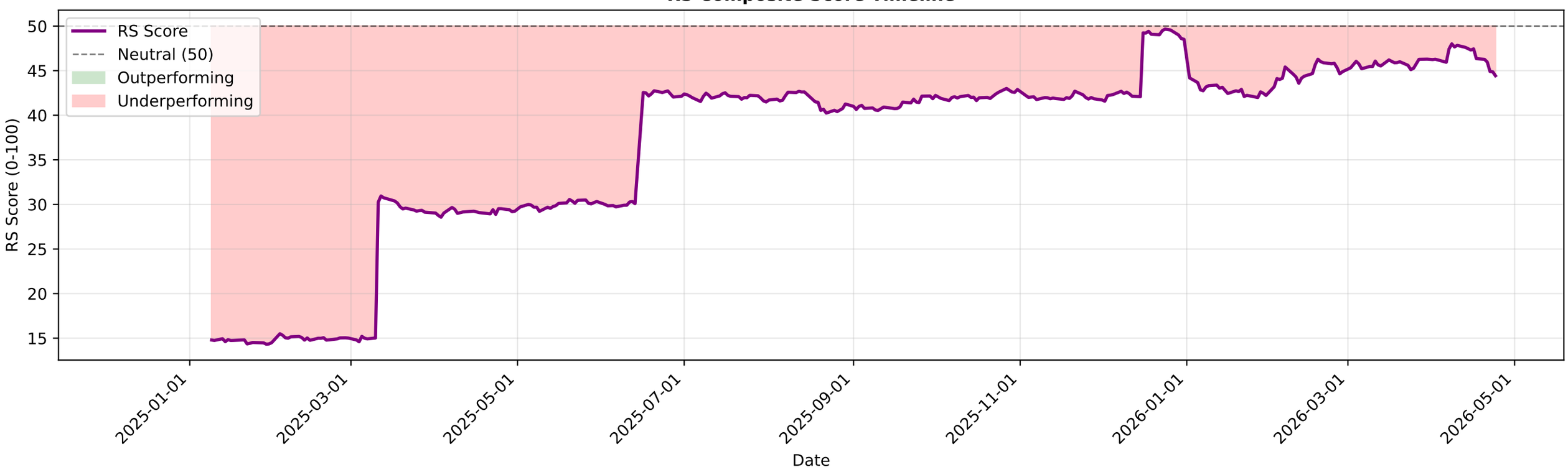
Price Performance Comparison (Normalized)



RS Ratio Trends (Multiple Timeframes)

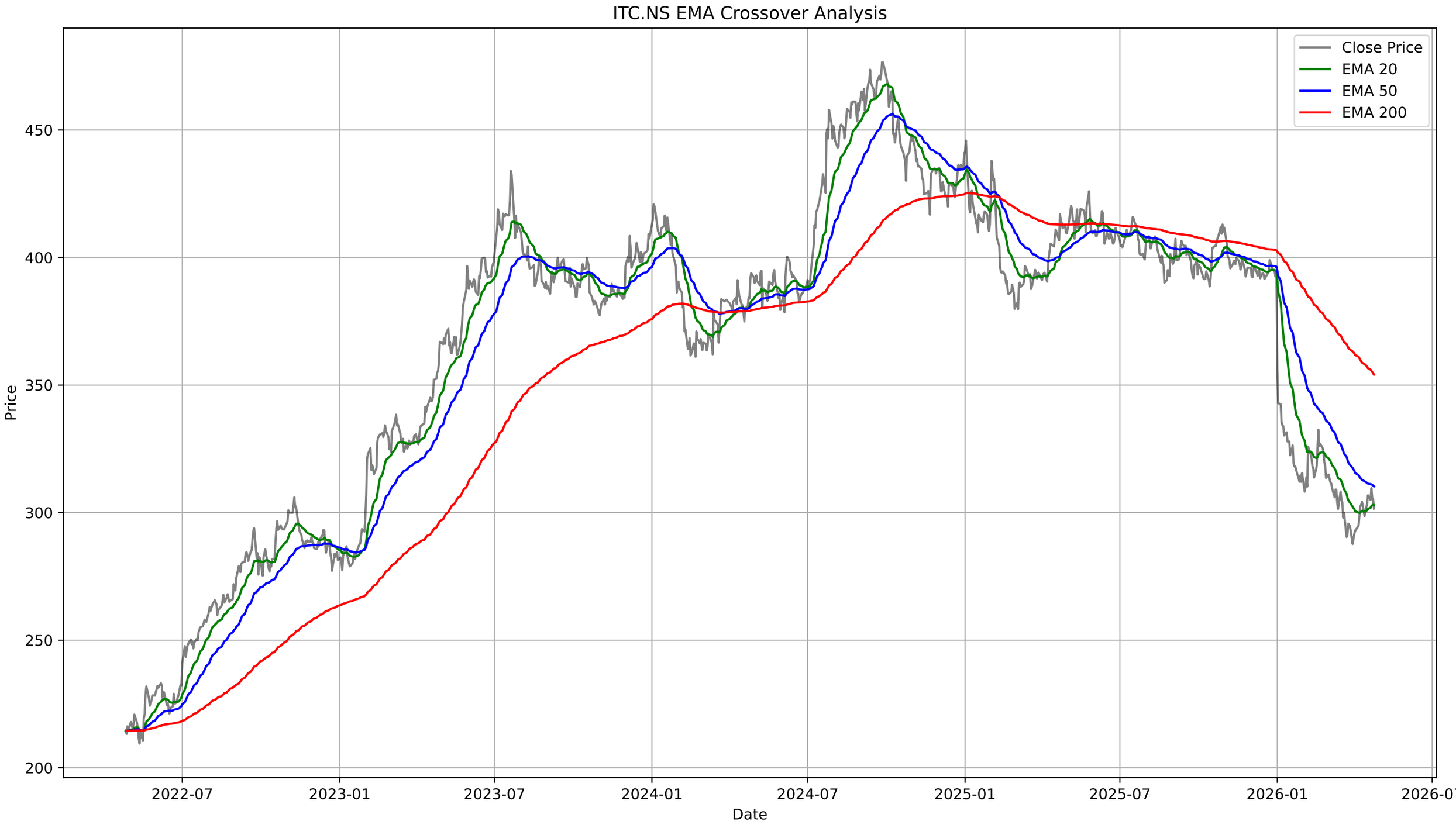


RS Composite Score Timeline



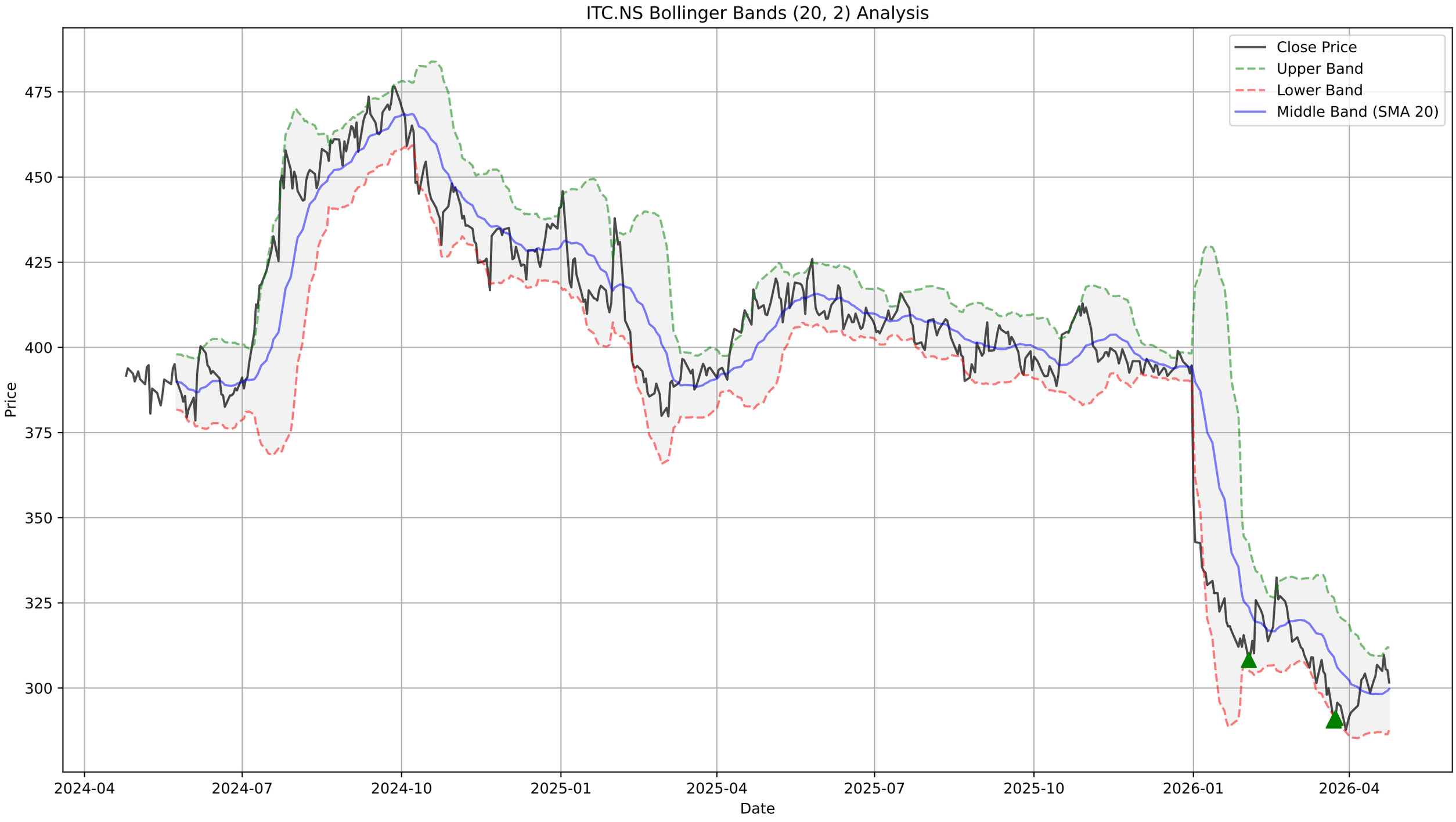
ITC.NS - EMA Crossover Summary

EMA 20:	302.95
EMA 50:	310.29
EMA 200:	354.10
Trend Status:	**Strong Downtrend**


ITC.NS EMA Crossover Analysis
Close Price
EMA 20
EMA 50
EMA 200
Price
450
400
350
300
250
200
2022-07
2023-01
2023-07
2024-01
2024-07
2025-01
2025-07
2026-01
2026-07
Date

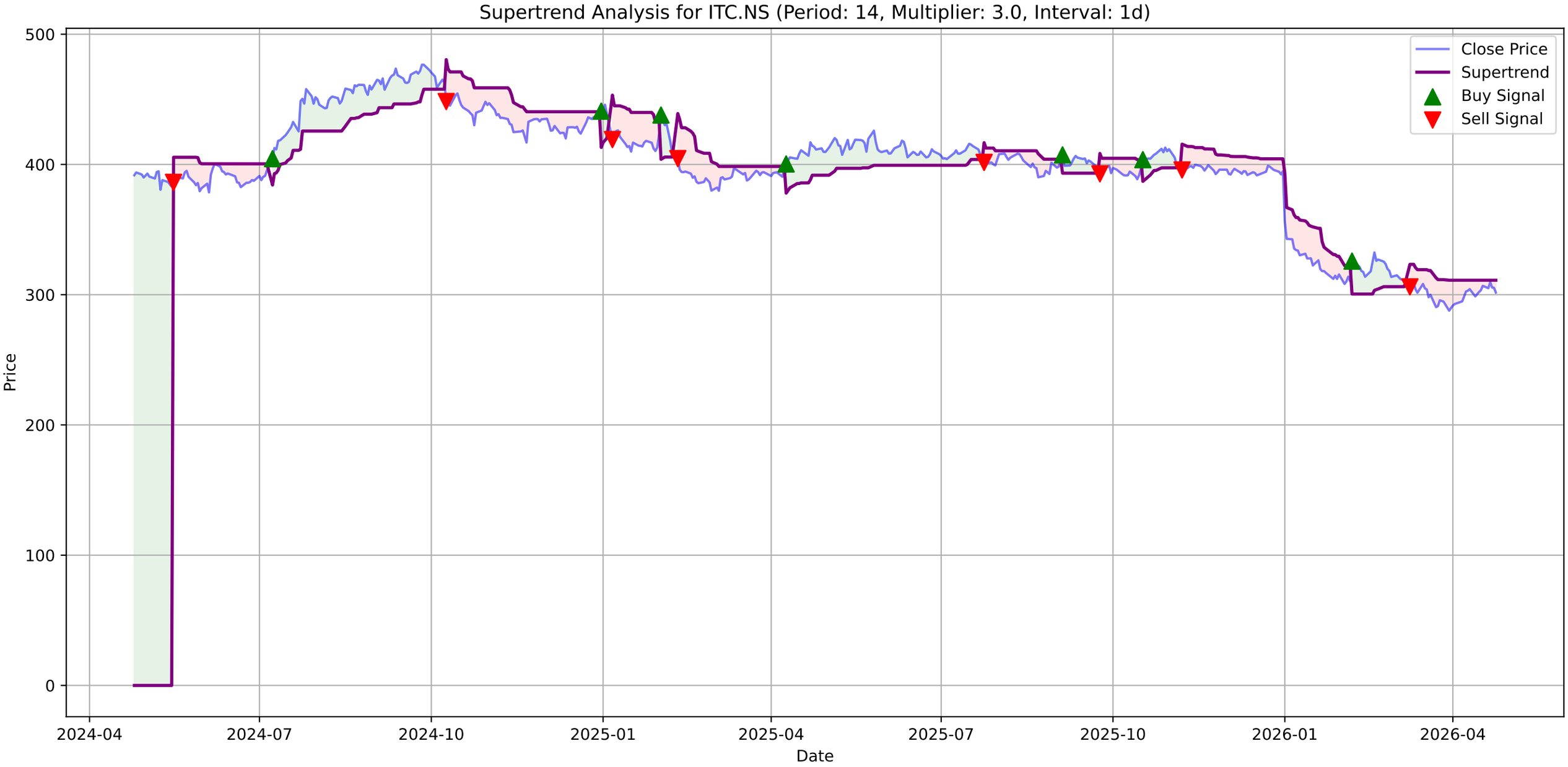
ITC.NS - Bollinger Bands Summary

Current Price:	301.60
Upper Band:	311.86
Middle Band (SMA 20):	299.74
Lower Band:	287.62
%B:	0.5766
Band Width:	0.0809
Status:	Upper Half
Signal:	None
Recent Signal 1:	**Buy Signal at 2026-02-02 00:00:00+05:30**
Recent Signal 2:	**Buy Signal at 2026-03-23 00:00:00+05:30**
Recent Signal 3:	**Buy Signal at 2026-03-24 00:00:00+05:30**


ITC.NS Bollinger Bands (20, 2) Analysis
Close Price
Upper Band
Lower Band
Middle Band (SMA 20)
Price
475
450
425
400
375
350
325
300
2024-04
2024-07
2024-10
2025-01
2025-04
2025-07
2025-10
2026-01
2026-04
Date

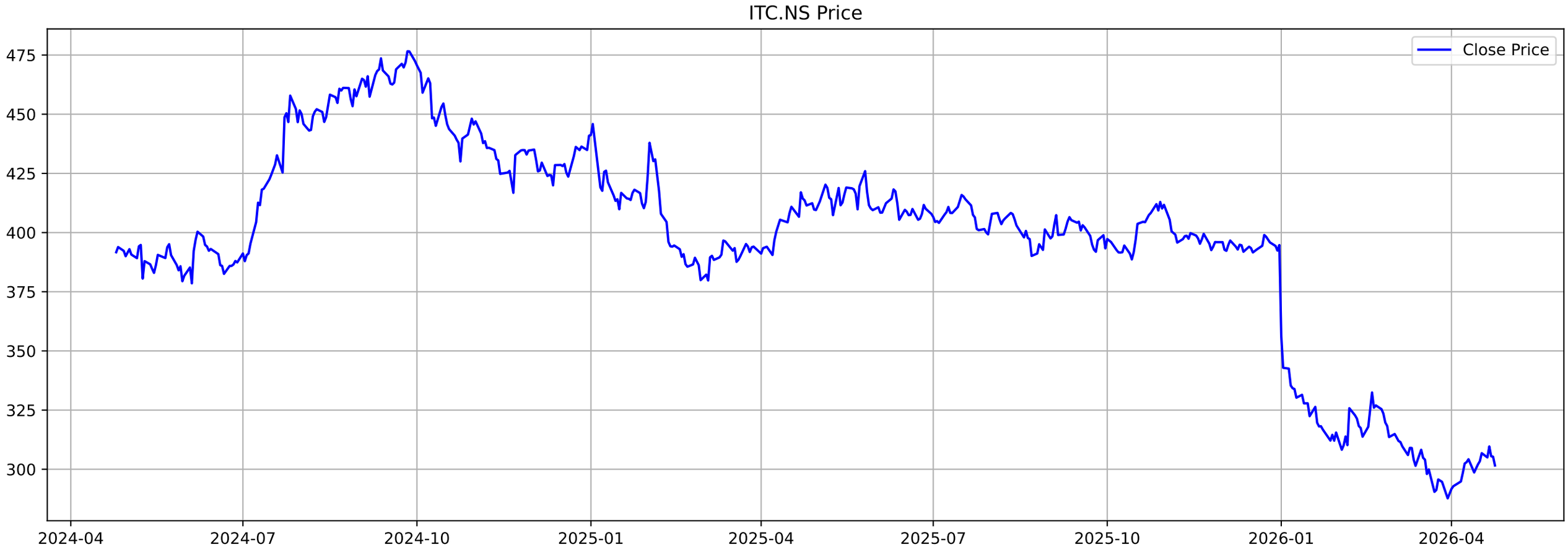
ITC.NS - Supertrend Summary

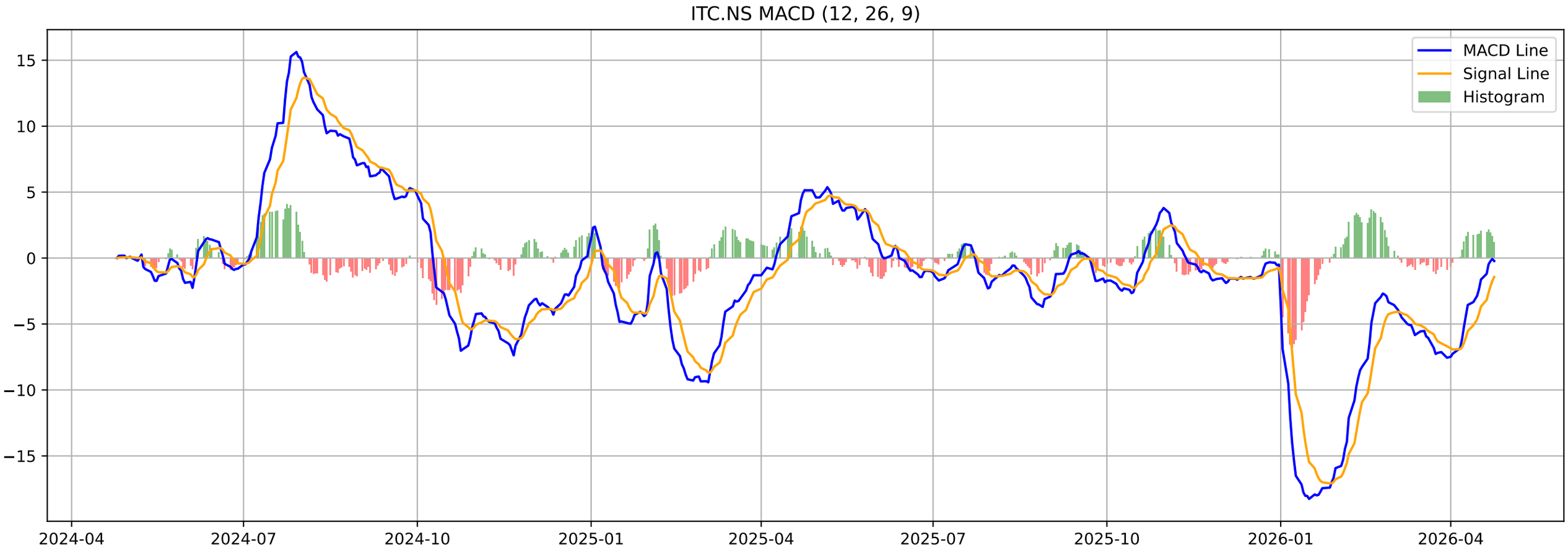
Status:	**DOWNTREND (Sell)**
Supertrend Value:	311.10
Signal Identified On:	2026-03-09


Supertrend Analysis for ITC.NS (Period: 14, Multiplier: 3.0, Interval: 1d)
Close Price
Supertrend
Buy Signal
Sell Signal
Price
Date
500
400
300
200
100
0
2024-04
2024-07
2024-10
2025-01
2025-04
2025-07
2025-10
2026-01
2026-04

ITC.NS - MACD Summary

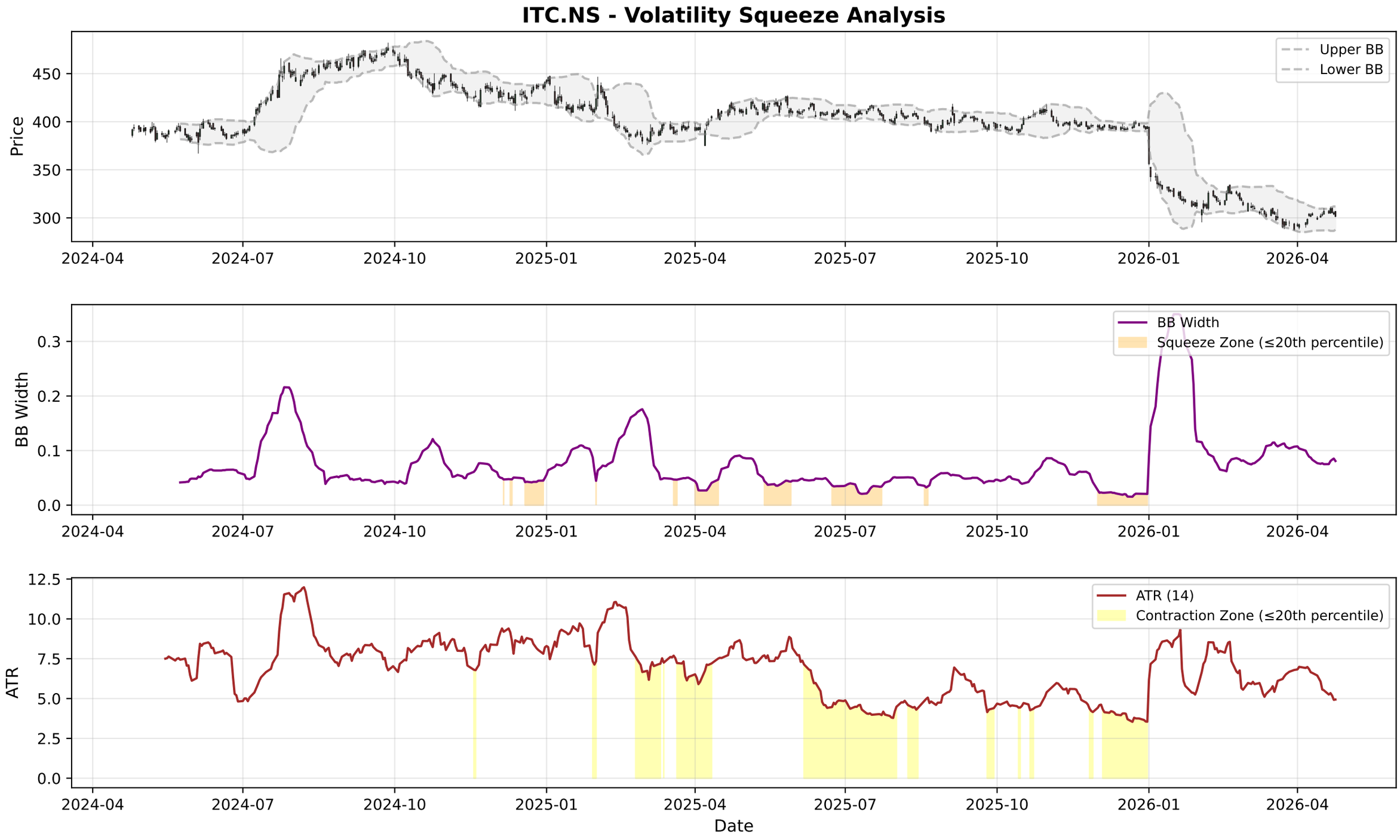
MACD Line:	-0.22
Signal Line:	-1.43
Histogram:	1.21
Trend:	**Bullish**
Momentum:	**Weakening**
Signal:	None


ITC.NS Price
Close Price
475
450
425
400
375
350
325
300
2024-04
2024-07
2024-10
2025-01
2025-04
2025-07
2025-10
2026-01
2026-04


ITC.NS MACD (12, 26, 9)
MACD Line
Signal Line
Histogram
15
10
5
0
−5
−10
−15
2024-04
2024-07
2024-10
2025-01
2025-04
2025-07
2025-10
2026-01
2026-04

ITC.NS - Volatility Squeeze Summary

BB Width:	0.0809
ATR:	4.9393
Total Signals:	0


ITC.NS - Volatility Squeeze Analysis
Price
Upper BB
Lower BB
BB Width
BB Width
Squeeze Zone (≤20th percentile)
ATR
ATR (14)
Contraction Zone (≤20th percentile)
Date
2024-04
2024-07
2024-10
2025-01
2025-04
2025-07
2025-10
2026-01
2026-04

ITC.NS - RSI-Volume Summary

Current RSI:	47.35
Current Volume:	17011704
Volume MA 20:	21137159
Bullish Divergences:	2
Bearish Divergences:	4
Bullish Div 1:	Date: 2025-10-14 00:00:00+05:30, Price: 388.65
Bullish Div 2:	Date: 2025-12-17 00:00:00+05:30, Price: 391.59
Bearish Div 1:	Date: 2024-09-26 00:00:00+05:30, Price: 476.59
Bearish Div 2:	Date: 2025-05-05 00:00:00+05:30, Price: 420.24

ITC.NS RSI-Volume Divergence Analysis
Price
475
450
425
400
375
350
325
300
2024-04
2024-07
2024-10
2025-01
2025-04
2025-07
2025-10
2026-01
2026-04
Relative Strength Index (RSI)
RSI
100
80
60
40
20
0
RSI (14)
Overbought (70)
Oversold (30)
Volume with Moving Averages
1e8
Volume
4
3
2
1
0
Volume MA-20
Volume MA-50
Date

ITC.NS - Volume Analysis

═══ VOLUME ANALYSIS ═══:	
Status:	**40 Signals Detected**
:	
2026-03-06 [-]:	Distribution Day
2026-03-13 [-]:	Distribution Day
2026-03-17 [-]:	Distribution Day
2026-03-20 [-]:	Climax Volume (Churning)
2026-04-22 [-]:	Distribution Day

ITC.NS - Volume Analysis
Close Price
Peaks
Troughs
Distribution
Climax Churn
Buying Exhaustion
Selling Exhaustion
Price
420
400
380
360
340
320
300
2025-05
2025-07
2025-09
2025-11
2026-01
2026-03
2026-05
1e8
Vol MA (20)
Volume
Volume
4
3
2
1
0
Date

ITC.NS - Candlestick Classification Summary

═══ CANDLESTICK CLASSIFICATION ═══:	
Latest Classification:	**Seller Control**
Recent Trend Score (10-day avg):	-0.20
:	
Distribution:	
No Control:	117
Seller Control:	63
Buyer Control:	46
Seller Strong Control:	2
Buyer Strong Control:	1

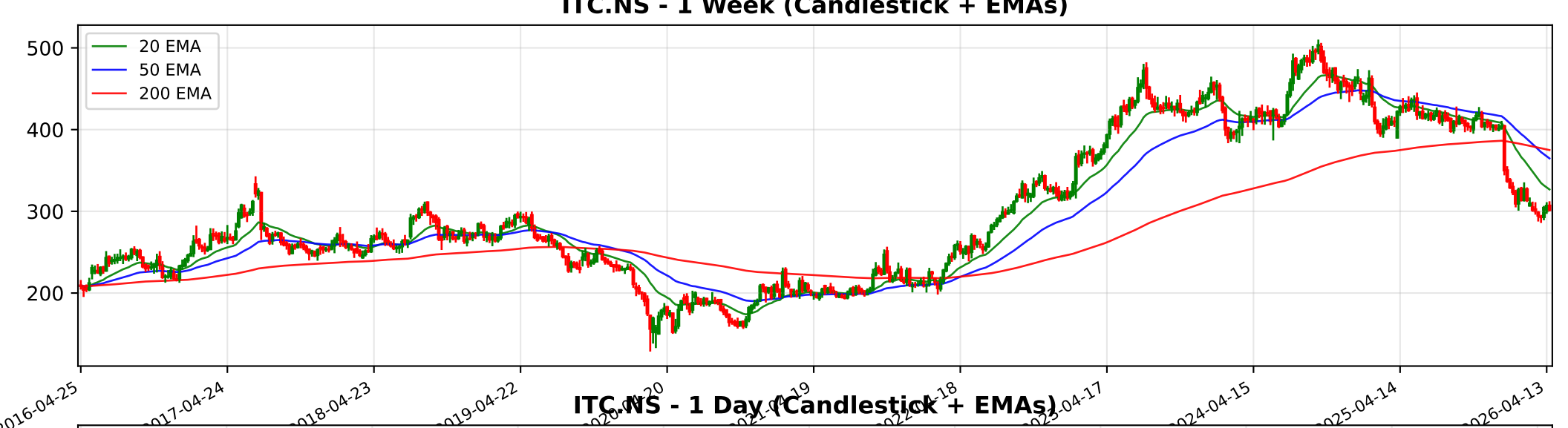
ITC.NS - Candlestick Classification
Seller Strong Control
Seller Control
No Control
Buyer Control
Buyer Strong Control
Price
420
400
380
360
340
320
300
1e8
Volume
2.5
2.0
1.5
1.0
0.5
0.0
2025-07-31
2025-08-28
2025-09-23
2025-10-20
2025-11-17
2025-12-11
2026-01-07
2026-02-03
2026-02-27
2026-03-27
Date

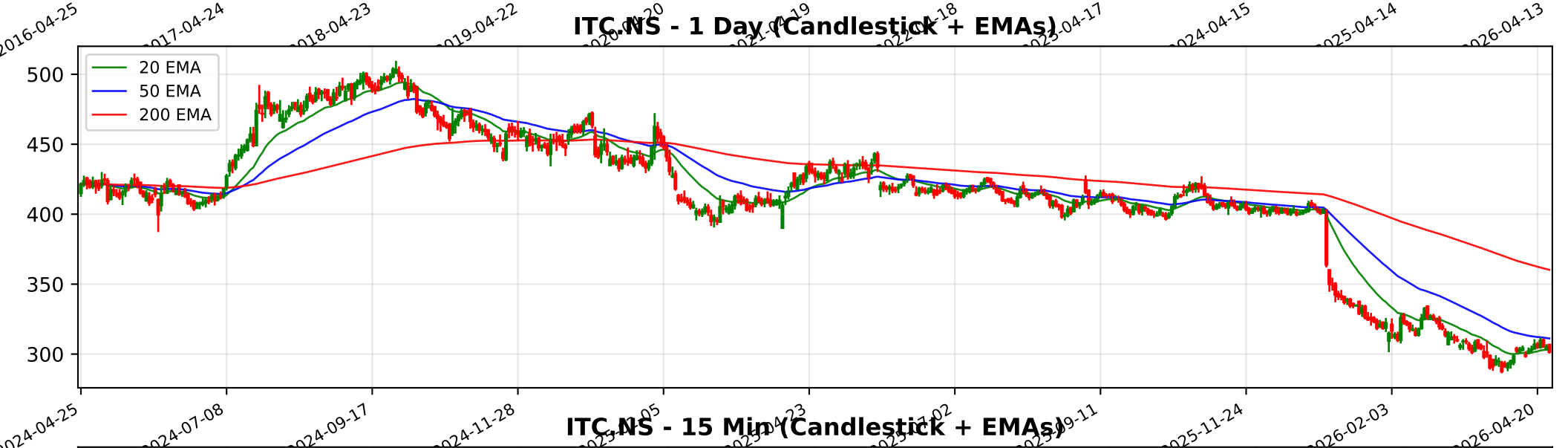
Multi-Timeframe Supertrend Analysis

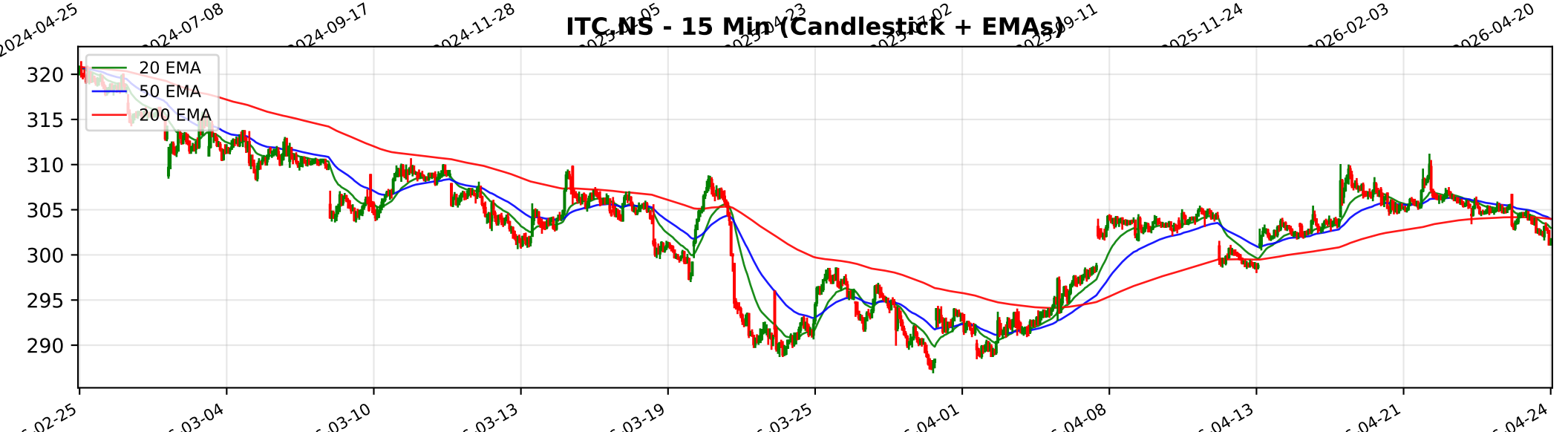
Timeframe	Status	Value	Last Price	Signal Date
1 Week	**DOWNTREND (Sell)**	315.6	301.6	2024-10-07
1 Day	**DOWNTREND (Sell)**	311.1	301.6	2026-03-09
15 Min	**DOWNTREND (Sell)**	303.54	301.45	2026-04-22

Multi-Timeframe MACD Analysis

Timeframe	Trend	Momentum	Signal
1 Week	**Bullish**	Strengthening	Bullish Crossover (Buy)
1 Day	**Bullish**	Weakening	No Signal
15 Min	**Bearish**	Strengthening	No Signal


ITC.NS - 1 Week (Candlestick + EMAs)
20 EMA
50 EMA
200 EMA
500
400
300
200
2016-04-25
2017-04-24
2018-04-23
2019-04-22
2024-04-15
2025-04-14
2026-04-13


ITC.NS - 1 Day (Candlestick + EMAs)
20 EMA
50 EMA
200 EMA
500
450
400
350
300
2024-04-25
2024-07-08
2024-09-17
2024-11-28
2025-11-24
2026-02-03
2026-04-20


ITC.NS - 15 Min (Candlestick + EMAs)
20 EMA
50 EMA
200 EMA
320
315
310
305
300
295
290
02-25
03-04
03-10
03-13
03-19
03-25
04-01
04-08
04-13
04-21
04-24

Trendlyne Snapshot - ITC_main

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MARKETS / SECTOR : FOOD, BEVERAGES & TOBACCO / INDUSTRY : CIGARETTES-TOBACCO PRODUCTS / ITC LTD.

ITC Ltd.

Ask MarketMind AI v1.5

NSE: ITC | BSE: 500875

ITC Live Share Price Today, Share Analysis and Chart

Mid-range Performer | In 8 Starfolio Baskets

IRAN WAR IMPACT The impact of the Iran-Israel war on ITC Ltd. is categorized as minimal to slightly negative. While the company has an export presence in the region, its primary operations and revenue drivers remain domestic. The most significant risks are i... Read More

301.60 -3.70 (-1.21%)

↓ 32.10% Fall from 52W High

17.9M NSE+BSE Volume

NSE 24 Apr, 2026 3:31 PM (IST)

Watchlist | Portfolio | Alert | My Notes

Overview | FORECASTER | Buy Sell Zone | F&O | Financials | Charts & Report | News | Reports | Technicals | Shareholding | Deals | Corporate Actions | Alerts | About

Durability score	Valuation Score	Momentum Score
75.0 / 100	48.7 / 100	35.6 / 100
High Financial Strength	Mid Valuation	Technically Neutral

Analyst Price Target — FORECASTER

359

1Yr Price target upside is 19%

Mid-range Performer These stocks have strong quality. Their reasonable financials and technicals make them potentially attractive to i... View Similar | Embed DVM

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SWOT Analysis

Check Before You Buy

VIEW FULL CHECKLIST

High rank 13 Positive • 10 Negative

56.5% Pass in checklist

0 45 55 100

PE Valuation Check

Right Now: Undervalued 123.9%

1 Year Forward: Undervalued 30%

INSIGHT High 5Yr PE Avg of 24.2 may distort upside values.

ITC Key Metrics

Preset Metrics: Preset Metrics

ROE Ann. %	Broker Average Target	Market Capitalization	Price to Book
49.6	432.75	377,888.8	5

Trendlyne Snapshot - ITC_forecaster

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MARKETS / SECTOR : FOOD, BEVERAGES & TOBACCO / INDUSTRY : CIGARETTES-TOBACCO PRODUCTS / ITC LTD.

ITC Ltd.

NSE: ITC | BSE: 500875

Mid-range Performer

In 8 Starfolio Baskets

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301.60 -3.70 (-1.21%)

↓ 32.10% Fall from 52W High

17.9M NSE+BSE Volume

NSE 24 Apr, 2026 3:31 PM (IST)

Watchlist | Portfolio | Alert | My Notes

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ITC - ITC - stock price prediction, stock forecast, target price, analyst ratings from 34 analysts

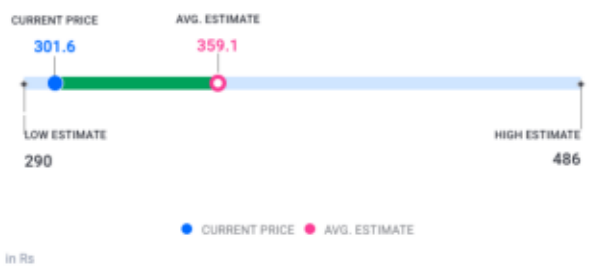
ITC has a share price target of Rs 359, revenue growth forecast of 7.6%, and profit growth estimate of -42.3% for FY26, based on top 34 analyst calls.

ITC FORECASTER - Analyst Estimates

FORECASTER DASHBOARD →

SHARE PRICE TARGET FORECAST

12 MONTH ESTIMATE



↑ HIT ITC's share price target is above the current price, with an upside of 19.1%

EPS FORECAST

QUARTER | ANNUAL

↑ HIT ITC's EPS was higher than average estimate 2 times in past 3 years

CONSENSUS RECOMMENDATION

34 ANALYST Recommendations

HOLD

The consensus recommendation from 34 analysts for ITC is HOLD